

REPORT · SEPTEMBER 2026

DSCR Creative & Labeling Playbook

Internal media-buyer playbook. DSCR refinance only. Housing Special Ad Category — creative is the targeting. Stamp from draft after founder approval.

1. What you're optimizing for

You are not targeting demographics. You are sorting investors by **what stops them from acting today**. That constraint decides the message, the label, and the ad set.

- **Who:** Real-estate investors who already own rentals. Operator energy. Not seniors. Not consumer relief.
- **Product:** DSCR refinance only — business-purpose. The property qualifies on rent vs payment, not W-2s / tax returns / DTI.
- **Big idea:** "The property qualifies itself." Honest trade: rates often higher than conventional — you win on access and process.

Governing question for every creative: What stops this investor from acting today? Not who they are. Not the property type. Not what they'd do with the money.

2. The four buckets

Three constraint buckets move people. One in-market lane harvests people already shopping. Every creative gets exactly one.

What stops this investor from acting today?

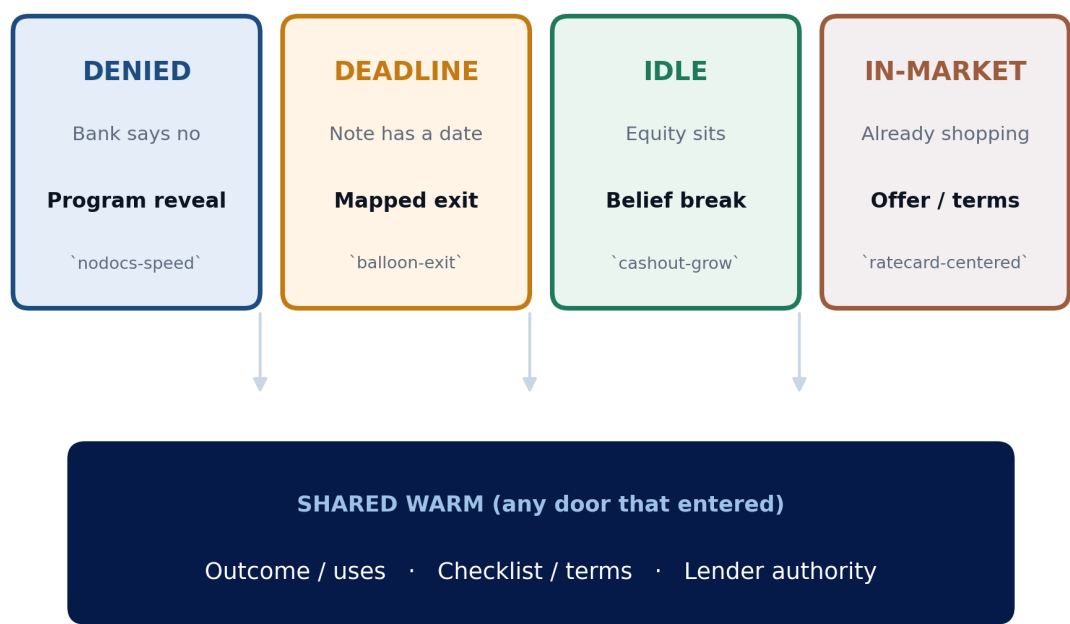


Figure 1: Bucket map — cold job per door, shared warm jobs after entry

Bucket	Constraint	Enemy	Cold job	Slug
DENIED	Would fail conventional today	Bank's basis	Program reveal	nodoccs-speed
DEADLINE	Note has a maturity date	The calendar	Mapped exit	balloon-exit
IDLE	Equity sits by choice	Status-quo bias	Belief break	cashout-grow
IN-MARKE T	Already shopping DSCR	—	Offer / terms	ratecard-center ed

What the ad sounds like

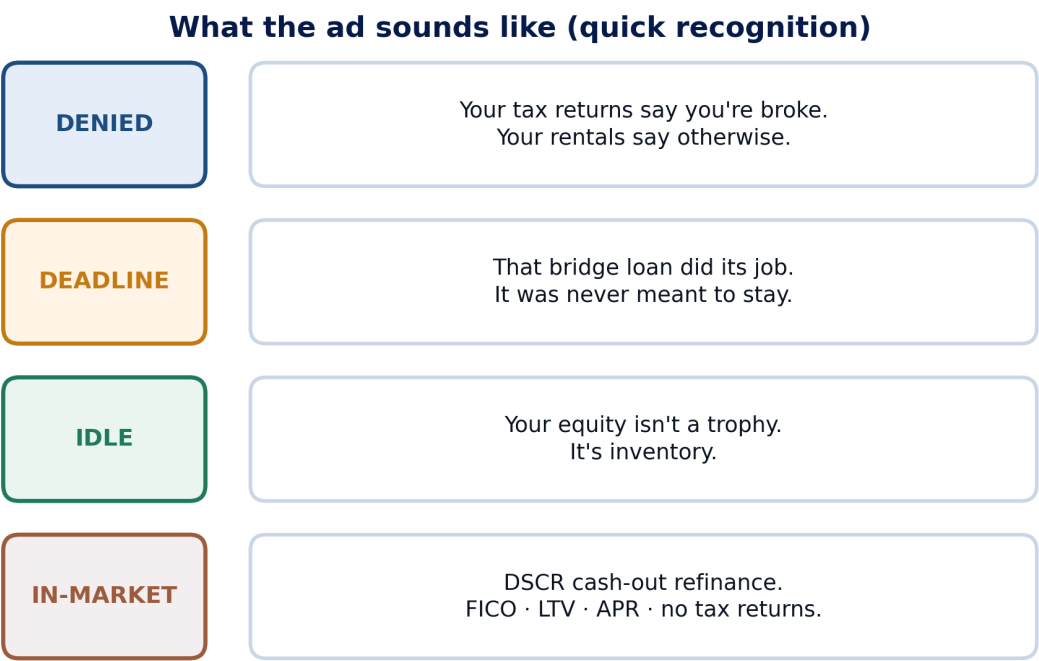


Figure 2: Quick recognition — if the hook doesn't match, re-bucket it

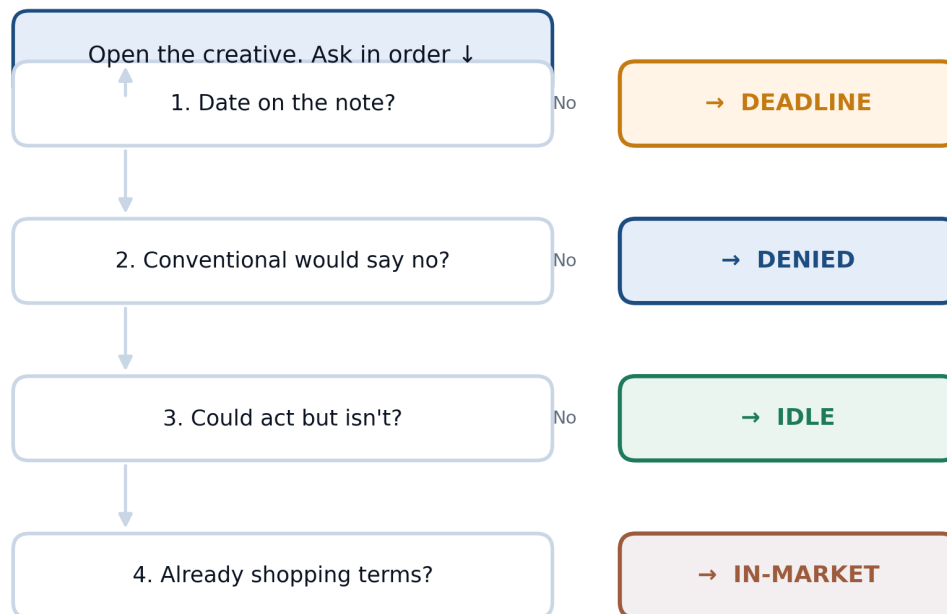
Aliases (do not invent peer labels)

Use	Old / alias names (not separate buckets)
DENIED	Write-Off, Self-Employed, property-count, STR, Foreign National
DEADLINE	Hard-Money, Balloon, Bridge
IDLE	Portfolio Scaler, Idle-Equity, Trapped, Dormant
IN-MARKET	Rate-card, terms shopper, product-aware

3. How to sort any ad

Overlap is real (balloon + write-offs). Priority order makes buckets mutually exclusive so Mr. Waiz rollups stay clean.

Sorting rule — one ad = one bucket



If the ad speaks to a pain, it is never IN-MARKET.

Figure 3: Check top to bottom — first yes wins

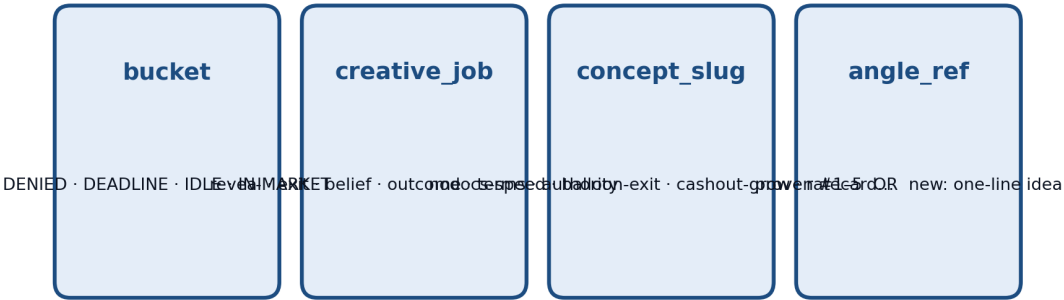
IN-MARKET is only for product-named + terms/spec creatives with no pain messaging. If the ad speaks to a constraint, it is never IN-MARKET.

Modifiers vs use cases (not buckets)

- **Modifiers** (write-offs, STR, FN, property-count) change the example inside DENIED — same enemy, same job.
- **Use cases** (pay off balloon, fund rehab, reserves, LLC) answer "what would you do with it?" — illustrate the ad; do not organize by them.

4. How to label every ad

Label every concept with these four fields



Ad name: dscr_{slug}_{format}_v{n} · Bucket/job live in tags — not in the ad_name token

Figure 4: Four fields required before a concept ships or registers

Ad name vs tags

TEXT

dscr_{concept-slug}_{format}_v{n}

Examples:

- dscr_nodocs-speed_st_v1
- dscr_balloon-exit_ugc_v1
- dscr_cashout-grow_st_v1
- dscr_ratecard-centered_st_v1

- Bucket + creative job live in overview / summary / tags — **not** inside the ad_name token.
- One primary creative job per ad. Don't average reveal + authority into one bland concept.

Proven angles → home

#	Angle	Bucket	Job	Slug
3	Did You Know?	DENIED	Program reveal	nodocs-speed
2	The Deadline	DEADLINE	Mapped exit	balloon-exit

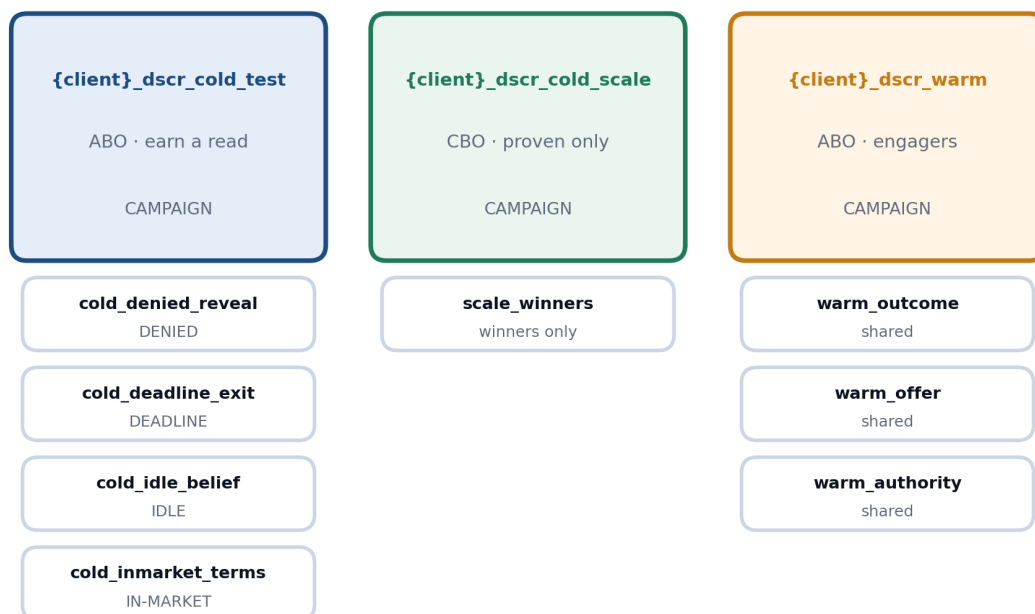
1	Idle-Equity Tax	IDLE	Belief break	cashout-grow
5	What You Could Do	IDLE → warm	Outcome / uses	cashout-grow var
4	Checklist / rate-card	Warm or IN-MARKET	Offer / terms	ratecard-centered
—	Lender authority	Shared warm	Why this LO	lo-authority*

* lo-authority / qualify-stack = proposed slugs — register before first use.

5. Campaign & ad set structure

Campaign = temperature + budget logic. Ad set = one bucket × one creative job. That is how you get a clean read under Andromeda.

Meta structure — campaigns & ad sets



Rule: one bucket × one creative job = one ad set = one primary creative

Figure 5: Launch shape — cold test earns reads; scale opens only after winners; warm owns shared jobs

Ad set	Bucket	Job	Slug
cold_denied_reveal	DENIED	Program reveal	nodocs-speed
cold_deadline_exit	DEADLINE	Mapped exit	balloon-exit
cold_idle_belief	IDLE	Belief break	cashout-grow
cold_inmarket_terms	IN-MARKET	Offer / terms	ratecard-centered
warm_outcome	Shared	Outcome / uses	cashout-grow var
warm_offer	Shared	Checklist / offer	qualify-stack*
warm_authority	Shared	Lender authority	lo-authority*

One bucket × one job = one ad set = one primary creative. Do not dump three angles into one ad set.

Budget barbell (while proving)

- ~80% DENIED + DEADLINE (+ IN-MARKET terms if approved numbers exist).
- ~20% IDLE — belief-change lane; don't kill it on day-3 CPL alone, but it still needs a terminal CPQL + review date.
- Warm authority opens when an engager pool exists — not as the only cold creative.
- Don't build cold_scale until a concept hits your CPL threshold for 7 consecutive days.

How to judge each bucket

Bucket	Touches	Judge cold on
DEADLINE	1–2	CPL → cost per qualified lead
DENIED	1–2	CPL → cost per qualified lead
IDLE	3+	Engagement / LP first, then CPQL with a kill date
IN-MARKET	1–2	CPL → CPQL (watch rate-shopper quality)
Authority (warm)	1	CPQL, booked rate, show rate — not vanity CTR

6. Media-buyer checklist

1. Read the creative. Run the sorting rule (deadline → denied → idle → in-market).
2. Fill four labels: bucket · creative_job · concept_slug · angle_ref.
3. Name the ad: dscr_{slug}_{format}_v{n}.
4. Place it in the matching ad set (one bucket × one job).
5. Cold numbers only if tokens are client-confirmed. Otherwise idea-first / number-free.
6. Never: purchase framing, guarantees, invented rates, RM/senior tone, literal "exclusive."

Cold launch order

When you need a starting slate: **DENIED** → **DEADLINE** → **IDLE**. Add IN-MARKET when the client's rate/spec sheet is approved for ads.

Source: dscr-creative-taxonomy.md · intelligence-icp-dscr.md · Waiz Media OS · Draft 2026-09-16